

In JavaScript, you can set cookies using the `document.cookie` property. A cookie is defined by a name and a value, followed by optional attributes like expiration, path, and security flags. 

1. Basic Cookie Setting

To create a simple session cookie (which expires when the browser is closed), assign a string to `document.cookie`: 

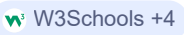
javascript 

```
document.cookie = "username=JohnDoe";
```

Note: This operation does not overwrite existing cookies; it adds or updates only the specified one. 

2. Adding Expiration

By default, cookies are deleted when the browser closes. To make them persist, use the `expires` or `max-age` attribute: 

- **expires:** Requires a date in UTC/GMT format. Use `date.toUTCString()` to format it correctly.
- **max-age:** Defines the cookie's lifespan in seconds (e.g., `86400` for one day). 

Example (using `max-age` for 7 days):

javascript 

```
document.cookie = "username=JohnDoe; max-age=" + (7 * 24 * 60 * 60) + "; path="/;
```

3. Key Attributes

- **path:** Specifies the URL path where the cookie is accessible. Setting `path=` makes it available across the entire website.
- **domain:** Defines the domain (and subdomains) that can access the cookie.
- **secure:** Ensures the cookie is only transmitted over HTTPS.
- **SameSite:** Controls cross-site cookie behavior (options: `Strict`, `Lax`, or `None`). 

4. Best Practices

- **Encoding:** Use `encodeURIComponent()` for names and values to ensure special characters (like `;` or `=`) don't break the cookie string.
- **Security:** Never store sensitive data like passwords in client-side cookies. Use the `HttpOnly` flag (set by the server) to prevent JavaScript from accessing sensitive session tokens.
- **Libraries:** For complex projects, consider a lightweight library like [js-cookie](#) to simplify the syntax:

javascript



```
Cookies.set('name', 'value', { expires: 7, path: '' });  
...
```

Stack Overflow +4

5. Deleting a Cookie

To delete a cookie, set its `expires` attribute to a date in the past or its `max-age` to `0`. You must use the same `path` and `domain` used when the cookie was created. Stack Overflow +1

javascript



```
document.cookie = "username=; expires=Thu, 01 Jan 1970 00:00:00 UTC;
```